Exact frequency uncertainty from neutrino angular moments

A four-disk diagnostic and sharp imaginary-axis envelopes

Working research draft · 1 November 2026 · Not submitted or peer reviewed

Abstract. Angular moment data do not specify a neutrino angular distribution. We study the inverse stability question: which unstable temporal frequencies can occur for some positive angular completion of given number density and flux? In the local, collisionless, axisymmetric fast limit, both longitudinal and transverse dispersion equations reduce to one complex Stieltjes value. Classical finite-interval moment theory turns each species' attainable values into two disks. A frequency is attainable exactly when four translated disks intersect. At most sixteen explicit candidates suffice, and exact algebraic witnesses or independent emptiness checks replace solver-status decisions. We derive sharp purely imaginary envelopes for equal masses and zero flux, with explicit attaining measures. Positive smooth completions can grow despite sharing their first and second number angular moments with a stable isotropic pair. All 504 predeclared classifications and 90 boundary/scaling cases have exact independent checks. These results concern a restricted uncertainty class, not prediction of an actual supernova background. Weyl-disk theory and completion ambiguity are established precedents; priority and practical impact of the specialized envelopes remain to be assessed.

1. Question and scope

Two-moment transport provides limited angular information. A closure chooses a completion; an uncertainty diagnostic asks what the supplied information permits. Completion ambiguity and crossing diagnostics are established topics [1], [2]. Quantum moment closures also support efficient stability calculations [3], [4]. The present output is different: **some** compatible angular distribution has a specified frequency, or **none** does. A possible frequency does not imply that every completion is unstable, and different frequencies may require different completions.

Let μ_+ and μ_- be positive measures on $u \in [-1,1]$, uniform in azimuth, with known masses N_+, N_- and axial number fluxes M_+, M_-. Their signed measure is $G = \mu_+ - \mu_-$. Heavy-flavor cancellation is an explicit pointwise symmetry assumption, not inferred from equal moments. Absorb a common self-interaction scale into masses, frequencies and wave numbers. All moments here are number weighted; calling the second moment thermodynamic pressure would require additional spectral assumptions.

We use reduced real $k > 0$ along the symmetry axis and $\operatorname{Im}\omega > 0$. Matter and background-current shifts are real and fixed by the supplied low moments. The model omits collisions, vacuum mixing, spatial variation and nonlinear saturation. Analytic angular integration, including its correct branch structure, is established [5]. No first three-dimensional solver or new generic moment theory is claimed.

2. Exact reduction of the stability question

Define $g_0 = N_+ - N_-$, $g_1 = M_+ - M_-$ and

$$I_j = \int_{-1}^{1} \frac{u^j}{\omega - ku}\,\mathrm{d}G(u), \quad J = I_0. \tag{1}$$

The polarization tensor is $\Pi = \eta + \int v \frac{v^T}{\omega - ku}\,\mathrm{d}G$, with the uniform azimuthal average understood, where $v = (1, \boldsymbol{v})$, $|\boldsymbol{v}| = 1$, and $\eta = \operatorname{diag}(1,-1,-1,-1)$. Axial symmetry splits it into a longitudinal block and two equal transverse factors:

$$D_L = (1 + I_0)(-1 + I_2) - I_1^2, \quad T = -1 + \frac{I_0 - I_2}{2}. \tag{2}$$

The identities $kI_1 = \omega J - g_0$ and $k^2 I_2 = \omega^2 J - \omega g_0 - k g_1$ cancel the quadratic terms in J. Thus

$$k^2 D_L = A_L J - B_L, \quad 2k^2 T = A_T J - B_T, \tag{3}$$

where

$$A_L = \omega^2 - k^2 + \omega g_0 - k g_1, \quad B_L = k^2 + \omega g_0 + k g_1 + g_0^2, \tag{4}$$

$$A_T = k^2 - \omega^2, \quad B_T = 2k^2 - \omega g_0 - k g_1. \tag{5}$$

With $z = \frac{\omega}{k}$ and species transforms $S_s = \int \mathrm{d}\frac{\mu_s}{z-u}$, the root equation becomes

$$S_+ - S_- = k\frac{B_X}{A_X}, \quad X \in \{L, T\}. \tag{6}$$

An upper-half-plane zero of A_L cannot also zero B_L, since $A_L + B_L = (\omega + g_0)^2$. It therefore gives no root. The transverse denominator vanishes only on the real axis. These exceptional cases are handled explicitly.

3. From positive measures to four disks

Put $z = x + iy$, $y > 0$, and consider one species of mass N and flux M, with $N \geq |M|$. Reweight its measure by $\mathrm{d}\rho = \mathrm{d}\frac{\mu}{|z-u|^2}$. For a proposed value $S = p + iq$, its first four moments satisfy

$$t_0 = -\frac{q}{y}, \quad t_1 = x t_0 - p, \tag{7}$$

$$t_2 = N + 2x t_1 - |z|^2 t_0, \quad t_3 = M + 2x t_2 - |z|^2 t_1. \tag{8}$$

The degree-three Hausdorff conditions are

$$H_\sigma = \begin{pmatrix} t_0 + \sigma t_1 & t_1 + \sigma t_2 \\ t_1 + \sigma t_2 & t_2 + \sigma t_3 \end{pmatrix} \geq 0, \quad \sigma \in \{-1, 1\}. \tag{9}$$

These are classical moment conditions. Finite-interval Weyl loci are direct antecedents [6]. Heide et al. give the intersection of two matrix balls for nondegenerate fixed-point transform values [7], Theorem 14.2. Its scalar, zero-order specialization supplies the nondegenerate mass/flux locus here, with the opposite transform sign. The generic two-disk construction is therefore a direct specialization of prior theory; the code also handles degenerate endpoint/zero-mass cases. Completing the square in each determinant gives the closed disks with

$$a_\sigma = (x + \sigma)^2 + y^2, \tag{10}$$

$$p_\sigma = \frac{N(2x + \sigma) - M}{2a_\sigma}, \tag{11}$$

$$q_\sigma = -\frac{(1 + \sigma x)(N + \sigma M) + 2Ny^2}{2a_\sigma y}, \quad r_\sigma^2 = \frac{(N + \sigma M)^2}{4y^2 a_\sigma}. \tag{12}$$

This is genuinely a disk condition, not just a determinant relaxation. The top-left entry is nonnegative throughout its disk; at its unique zero tangent, the off-diagonal vanishes and the remaining diagonal is $N + \sigma M \geq 0$. Zero-radius cases correctly describe fixed endpoint atoms or zero mass.

Finite diagnostic. Translate the two minus-species disks by the target $k\frac{B_X}{A_X}$. Their intersection with the two plus-species disks is nonempty if and only if the frequency is attainable. A nonempty intersection of four closed disks contains either a disk center or a pairwise boundary-intersection point. There are four centers and at most twelve pair points. Coincident/concentric circles are skipped, and zero-radius centers remain candidates. If boundary arcs never switch inside the intersection, one full disk is contained in the others and its center works; otherwise an arc switch is a pair candidate. Tangential singleton intersections are also included.

Rational input gives rational centers and squared radii. Pair candidates lie in a real quadratic field. Exact sign checks decide membership, with no angular quadrature or numerical optimizer. Arithmetic-operation count is bounded independently of angular-grid size; bit complexity still depends on input size and separation from degeneracy. The implementation prefers feasible boundary candidates.

Attainment and proof checking. For feasible S, let $\Delta = t_0 t_2 - t_1^2$. At rank one the measure is one atom. At rank two, the Gaussian quadrature polynomial $u^2 + au + b$ has

$$a = \frac{-t_0 t_3 + t_1 t_2}{\Delta}, \quad b = \frac{-t_2^2 + t_1 t_3}{\Delta}. \tag{13}$$

Its roots and weights reconstruct ρ; multiplying weights by $|z-u|^2$ reconstructs μ. Exact support, nonnegativity, moment and transform checks accompany the witness. Generic node formulas may introduce another square root beyond the coefficient field. A separate standard-library checker imports neither the production code nor its optimizer. It replays empty intersections and verifies witnesses; unresolved numerical proposals carry no authority.

4. Sharp imaginary-axis envelopes

Assume $N_+ = N_- = N > 0$ and $M_+ = M_- = 0$. For reduced frequencies $\omega = i\gamma, \gamma > 0$, the sharp attainable ranges are

$$\gamma_L^2 \le N^2 \frac{k}{k+2N}, \quad \gamma_T^2 \le N^2 \frac{k}{4(k+N)}. \tag{14}$$

These bounds optimize over **all positive axial measures with those moments**. They are not proved upper bounds for roots with nonzero real part.

Proof of the upper bounds. Write $y = \frac{\gamma}{k}$. Each species lens is centrally symmetric about its common imaginary center. Its circle centers have real parts $\pm c$, with

$$c = \frac{N}{2(1+y^2)}, \quad r = \frac{N}{2y\sqrt{1+y^2}}. \tag{15}$$

The difference body is twice the centered lens. A real transform difference is therefore attainable exactly when its magnitude is at most $2(r-c)$. The longitudinal and transverse targets are respectively $-\frac{k}{1+y^2}$ and $2\frac{k}{1+y^2}$. Substitution and squaring positive quantities give Equation 14. Equal imaginary transform components realize the whole horizontal interval, so no missing imaginary-part constraint remains.

Explicit attainers. For $0 < a < 1$, take the actual species measures

$$\mu_+ = \frac{N}{1+a}(\delta_a + a\delta_{-1}), \quad \mu_- = \frac{N}{1+a}(\delta_{-a} + a\delta_1). \tag{16}$$

Both have mass N and flux zero. Their signed transform is

$$J = -2Nk^3 \frac{a(1-a)}{(\omega^2 - k^2a^2)(\omega^2 - k^2)}. \tag{17}$$

The longitudinal root has $\gamma^2 = 2Nka - k(k+2N)a^2$. Maximizing gives $a = \frac{N}{k+2N}$ and the first bound. Swapping species gives a transverse root with $\gamma^2 = Nka - k(k+N)a^2$, maximized at $a = \frac{N}{2(k+N)}$. Varying a below its optimizer realizes every positive sub-bound rate. For measures, equality is attained; under smooth-density restrictions, these atomic extrema are approached rather than asserted attained.

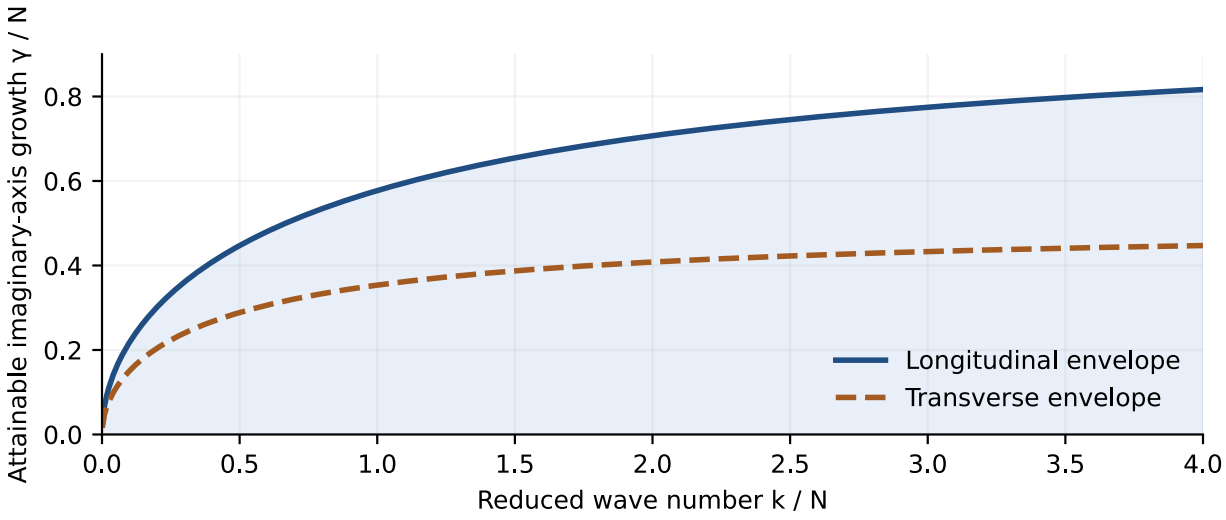


Figure 1: Sharp imaginary-axis attainability envelopes. Each allowed point has some compatible completion; the shaded region is not a dispersion branch of one background. No bound over arbitrary real frequency is asserted.

5. Smooth ambiguity with identical low moments

The attaining family has identical per-species second scalar moment Na and isotropic transverse second moments $\frac{N(1-a)}{2}$. At $N = k = 1$, the longitudinal optimizer has $a = \frac{1}{3}$, so both full number second-moment tensors equal $\frac{I}{3}$. Two uniform species have exactly the same moments and $G = 0$, hence are stable. Indeed, zero signed mass and flux make the shifted zero-mode spatial problem real symmetric; a finite-k result here is not continuity from an already unstable zero mode.

Convolve the two attaining angular measures on the sphere with a normalized rotationally invariant von Mises-Fisher kernel of concentration κ. Its action scales each spherical-harmonic degree without mixing degrees. The vanishing dipole and quadrupole coefficients remain exactly zero. The resulting strictly positive smooth densities therefore retain mass one, zero flux and second tensor $\frac{I}{3}$. Their axial density with respect to $\mathrm{d}u$ is

$$f_+(u) = \frac{\kappa}{2\sinh\kappa}\left[\frac{3}{4}e^{\kappa\frac{u}{3}}\,\mathrm{I}_0\left(\kappa\sqrt{8\frac{1-u^2}{9}}\right) + \frac{1}{4}e^{-\kappa u}\right], \quad f_-(u) = f_+(-u). \tag{18}$$

The validated integration uses an entire hypergeometric representation of the Bessel factor, so no square-root branch is hidden in the analytic callback. The real longitudinal dispersion is integrated with Arb balls. Strict opposite signs at rational positive-γ endpoints certify a growing root by continuity, then bisection gives width below 10^{-4}.

The fixed concentrations $2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64$ were all reported. Four brackets certify rates near 0.26694, 0.41343, 0.49356 and 0.53520 for $\kappa = 8, 16, 32, 64$. The first two concentrations produced no bracket in the specified search; that is not a proof of stability. Independent SciPy integration reproduced all four roots inside the saved brackets and complex determinant residuals below 4×10^{-16}.

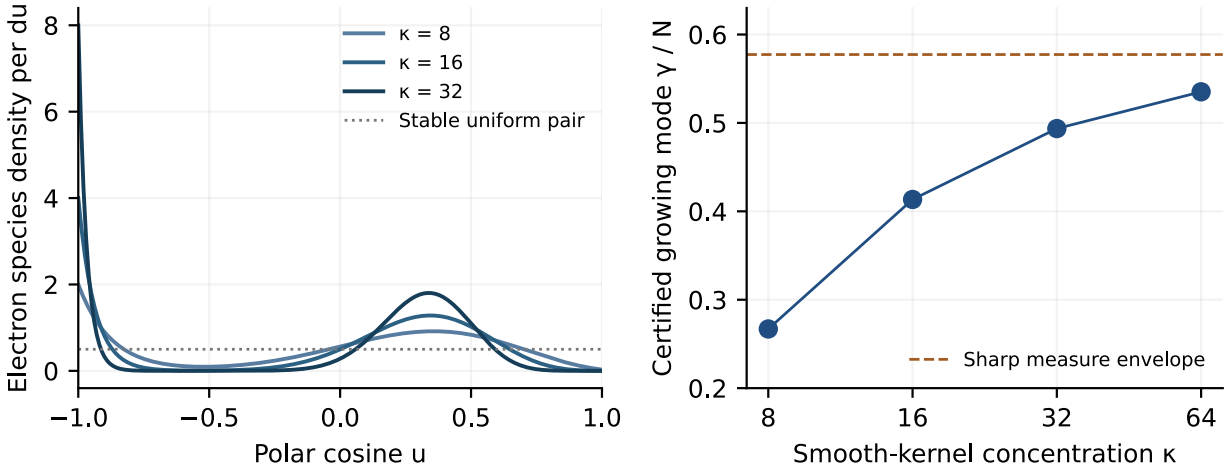


Figure 2: Left: positive smooth electron-species completions; antineutrinos are reflected. Every curve has the same first and second number moments as the stable uniform pair. Right: validated growing-root brackets approach the sharp measure envelope. Concentrations 2 and 4 had no certified bracket and are not plotted as zero growth.

6. Reproducible checks and what they establish

The predeclared screen uses three moment classes, two nonzero wave numbers, seven real frequencies, six positive imaginary frequencies and both sectors: 504 existential decisions. The classes are equal masses/zero flux, the normalized axial projection of the published fiducial counter-flux moments [3], and a single-positive-species control. This is not reproduction of a neutron-star-merger snapshot or its actual instability rates.

Moment class	Possible	Impossible
Equal masses, zero flux	34	134
Fiducial axial moments	38	130
Single positive species	0	168
Total	**72**	**432**

All 504 decisions have independent exact checks. The zero-flux class contains 22 distinct attainable (k, ω) pairs although it also contains the stable uniform completion. A generic numerical moment-LMI proposer with exact proof

checks agrees on this screen. Angular-grid LPs at 32, 128 and 512 nodes agree at these points as well; no sampled accuracy advantage over those grids is claimed.

An additional 90 designed tests cover exact envelope boundaries, perturbations down to 10^{-12} and common scales from 10^{-50} to 10^{50}. Every exact decision matches the proved threshold. At the two unit-scale boundaries the attaining interior cosine is $\frac{3}{8}$, absent from all three uniform grids. Exact Farkas checks certify each grid problem infeasible, while a continuous positive-measure witness exists. This is an intentional discretization stress, not a random error rate or a numerical LP failure. The numerical proposer left two unit-scale stress cases unresolved; those flags are not negative answers.

Independent tests include rational atomic moments, direct sector identities, exact radical ordering, degenerate circles, malformed certificate rejection and boundary attainers. The initial preregistration was amended before the full screen to accept algebraic disk-emptiness proofs in place of rational duals. Four development smoke points overlapped its planned grid and are disclosed. The records are task-local, not externally timestamp-registered. The first screen attempt stopped on a reference-baseline type conversion; its corrected complete run and failure log are retained.

Exploratory medians are about 4.35 ms for the geometric decision and 6.18 ms for independent checking, versus 8.02 ms for the numerical certified proposer. These are development timings with uncontrolled background work, not a controlled speedup claim. A generic optimized conic implementation and direct classical Weyl-circle software have not been benchmarked. Such comparisons remain necessary before broad efficiency claims.

7. Novelty assessment and remaining work

The underlying finite-interval transform loci are classical [6], [7]. In particular, the two-ball theorem specializes directly to the scalar mass/flux problem; combining two species does not make that moment theory new. Closure/completion ambiguity and low-moment crossing disagreement are also explicit predecessors [1]. Consequently, the defensible candidate contribution is the specialized exact frequency diagnostic with attaining completions, the sharp constrained imaginary-axis envelopes, and the explicit smooth matched-second-moment instability example. Focused independent searches found no matching envelope, but absence from a search is not proof of priority.

The construction has survived independent mathematical and physics review within its model; those reviewers were fresh-context model agents, not external human referees. Practical importance remains unproved. Needed next steps include expert priority review, realistic number-moment provenance, more physical classes and independent hardware reproduction. A justified uncertainty class must incorporate any available energy/occupancy or angular regularity information. Arbitrary wave-vector directions, full three-dimensional angular uncertainty, collisions, nonlinear flavor evolution and actual astrophysical consequences remain outside this result. A finite map is not a proof about all frequencies or all wave numbers.

The paper is therefore a research draft with a surviving narrow theoretical candidate, not a claim of an extraordinary breakthrough or publication readiness. No repository publication, submission or external outreach has occurred.

Bibliography

[1] L. Johns and H. Nagakura, "Fast flavor instabilities and the search for neutrino angular crossings," *Physical Review D*, vol. 103, p. 123012, 2021, doi: 10.1103/PhysRevD.103.123012.

[2] S. Abbar, "Searching for Fast Neutrino Flavor Conversion Modes in Core-collapse Supernova Simulations," *Journal of Cosmology and Astroparticle Physics*, vol. 5, p. 27, 2020, doi: 10.1088/1475-7516/2020/05/027.

[3] J. Froustey *et al.*, "Neutrino fast flavor oscillations with moments: linear stability analysis and application to neutron star mergers," *Physical Review D*, vol. 109, p. 43046, 2024, doi: 10.1103/PhysRevD.109.043046.

[4] J. Froustey, J. P. Kneller, and G. C. McLaughlin, "Quantum maximum entropy closure for small flavor coherence," *Physical Review D*, vol. 111, p. 63022, 2025, doi: 10.1103/PhysRevD.111.063022.

[5] T. Morinaga and S. Yamada, "Linear stability analysis of collective neutrino oscillations without spurious modes," *Physical Review D*, vol. 97, p. 23024, 2018, doi: 10.1103/PhysRevD.97.023024.

[6] P. di Dio, "Weyl Circles for one-dimensional Moment Problems." [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1506.06589

[7] M. Heide, B. Fritzsche, B. Kirstein, and C. Mädler, "Weyl Sets in a Non-degenerate Truncated Matricial Hausdorff Moment Problem," *Complex Analysis and Operator Theory*, vol. 18, p. 82, 2024, doi: 10.1007/s11785-024-01525-1.